

Complaint Resolution Guide

Internal Reference | Customer Experience Team

This guide is intended for SmartTech Customer Experience representatives and outlines the standard procedures for receiving, categorising, escalating, and resolving customer complaints.

Following this guide ensures consistent, empathetic, and efficient service across all customer touchpoints — phone, email, live chat, and social media.

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Department	Customer Experience	Approved By	Chief Operations Officer

1. Complaint Categories

All customer complaints must be classified into one of the following categories upon receipt:

Category	Examples	Priority
Product Quality	Defective item, wrong product, damage	High
Delivery	Late delivery, missing package, wrong address	High
Billing & Payments	Incorrect charge, refund not received	High
Technical Support	Device not working, app crash	Medium
Customer Service	Rude agent, long wait times	Medium
General Enquiry	Product info, policy clarification	Low

2. Complaint Intake Process

2.1 Greeting & Acknowledgement

All complaints must be acknowledged within the following timeframes:

- Phone: Immediately upon connection.
- Email: Automated acknowledgement within 5 minutes; human response within 2 hours.
- Live Chat: Within 60 seconds of the customer's first message.
- Social Media: Within 1 hour during business hours (9 AM–7 PM IST).

2.2 Information Collection

Collect the following details before proceeding:

- Customer's full name and registered email / phone number.
- Order ID or Invoice number.
- Product model and serial number (if applicable).
- Date of purchase and date of issue.
- Detailed description of the complaint.
- Any supporting evidence (photos, videos, screenshots).

3. Escalation Matrix

Level	Handler	Resolution Time	Trigger Condition
L1 – Frontline	Customer Service Rep	Same day	Standard enquiries
L2 – Senior Rep	Senior CS Associate	24 hours	Unresolved at L1 > 4 hrs
L3 – Team Lead	CS Team Leader	48 hours	Unresolved at L2 > 24 hrs
L4 – Manager	CS Manager	72 hours	Escalated by customer or L3
L5 – Executive	VP Customer Experience	5 business days	Legal threat or social media viral

4. Resolution Guidelines

4.1 Product & Delivery Complaints

Verify the complaint against order records. If valid, initiate replacement or refund per the Refund and Return Policy (DOC-RFD-002). Always offer a goodwill gesture (e.g., discount coupon) for high-priority cases resolved at L3 or above.

4.2 Billing Complaints

Cross-reference the customer's claim with the billing system. Never process a refund without supervisor approval for amounts exceeding █10,000. Document all financial adjustments in the CRM system with justification notes.

4.3 Technical Complaints

Follow the relevant troubleshooting guide (Laptop: DOC-LTG-006, Mobile: DOC-MPM-007) before escalating. If the issue is unresolvable remotely, schedule an on-site visit or authorised service centre referral within 48 hours.

5. Complaint Closure & Follow-Up

A complaint is considered closed only when the customer confirms satisfaction or the resolution has been implemented and communicated. All closed complaints must be:

- Logged in the CRM with resolution notes and category tags.
- Reviewed by the Team Lead for quality assurance.
- Followed up within 48 hours via a customer satisfaction survey (CSAT).
- Flagged for root-cause analysis if the same issue recurs more than 3 times.

6. Prohibited Actions

The following actions are strictly prohibited during complaint handling:

- Arguing with or dismissing a customer's complaint without investigation.
- Promising resolutions outside your authorisation level.
- Sharing customer data with unauthorised third parties.
- Closing a complaint without customer acknowledgement.
- Making negative comments about SmartTech products or policies to the customer.